

Android Studio is designed particularly for Android development to accelerate the android application development process and make it simpler. In this chapter, we will be harnessing the power of Android Studio to build an Android Application from scratch, in real time. We will be building a RSS Feed Reader android application, which will be pulling RSS Feeds from a pre-defined source in our code and displaying it in a List.

Before diving in directly towards building the app, it would be better to understand some common terminologies used in the Android application development process. You can find the apk here - <https://goo.gl/3dYt8D>

1.Android Basics

Activity

In Android, an activity represents just a single screen with a user interface. Activity is basically a Java code that supports UI. Activity class is an inbuilt class in Android and every application which supports UI must inherit it to create windows. A more-than-basic app would have more than one activity and these activities, though independent of each other, work together to form a cohesive user experience.

Intent

Intent is a type of asynchronous message that allows application components to request resources from other Android components. The basic principle of Intents is to allow you to interact with components contributed by other applications as well as components from the same applications. For example, you can fire up the system browser through your app using intents.

Intents are of two types – Implicit and Explicit. In implicit intent, the component is not specified and the android system by itself decides the best suitable component for the intent call whereas in explicit intent the component is defined.

Gradle

In Android Studio, the building of Android projects is handled by the Gradle build system. When you create a new project in Android studio, the Gradle build scripts are created automatically. The Gradle runtime is pre-configured with Android Studio, so no additional installation is required.